

STEPH SIMMONS

CLOUD ENGINEER / AWS SOLUTIONS ARCHITECT / PLATFORM ENGINEER

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PROFILE

I build cloud systems that are ready for the people who have to operate them after launch.

Cloud Engineer and AWS Solutions Architect with a decade of enterprise IT experience and a portfolio of production systems built end-to-end on AWS. Designs event-driven, serverless, and containerized architectures with infrastructure-as-code, OIDC-based CI/CD, and cross-account observability.

AT A GLANCE

10+ years enterprise IT

3 deployed AWS products

2026 AWS SAA certified

CURRENT IS Supervisor · Scrum Master

SELECTED ENGINEERING WORK

RabbitHole INDEPENDENT PROJECT

[LIVE ↗](#) [GITHUB ↗](#)

Event-driven AI video platform on AWS with adaptive-bitrate HLS delivery, live WebSocket status, speech indexing, and semantic search.

ECS Fargate · EventBridge · SQS · Lambda · ffmpeg · AWS Transcribe · Terraform · OIDC CI/CD

- Chose ECS Fargate over Lambda for CPU-bound, long-running ffmpeg transcoding where Lambda limits and cold starts would hurt the experience.
- Decoupled uploads with EventBridge and SQS so the API never blocks; the processing fleet scales to zero between jobs.
- Eliminated long-lived deployment credentials with OIDC-based GitHub Actions and remote Terraform state.

QuicLens CO-FOUNDER / CLOUD ENGINEER

[LIVE ↗](#)

Multi-tenant research analytics SaaS for neurodegenerative disease and prion research labs, replacing manual R scripts and Excel with structured cloud-native analysis.

TypeScript · AWS CDK · Lambda (Docker) · API Gateway · DynamoDB · WorkOS SSO · React · FastAPI

- Enforced tenant isolation at the DynamoDB partition key and IAM boundary, not only in application logic.
- Moved scientific Lambda workloads to Docker containers after ARM-incompatible libraries failed under the managed runtime.
- Built a 92-test validation suite against researcher-validated ground truth before a user touched the platform.

PureZen AWS ACADEMY CAPSTONE

[LIVE ↗](#) [GITHUB ↗](#)

Fully serverless AI spa-booking platform with a conversational concierge and operational admin assistant grounded in live application data.

AWS CDK · Lambda · DynamoDB · Anthropic Claude · Ollama · React · FastAPI

- Migrated from CPU-only Ollama after diagnosing 10-40 second response times, enabling a fully serverless architecture with Anthropic Claude.
- Resolved availability deterministically against live DynamoDB state rather than generating it with the model.
- Used a regex-first router for routine requests and Anthropic tool use for data-backed admin queries.

EXPERIENCE

Independent Engineer · Product & Infrastructure 2021-Present

RabbitHole · QuicLens · PureZen

- Design and ship production systems end-to-end in isolated AWS environments using infrastructure-as-code and automated delivery.
- Apply enterprise-grade operational readiness: observability, documentation, supportability, security boundaries, and clean handoff.

IS Supervisor · Scrum Master 2025-Present

Mutual of Omaha · Omaha, NE

- Lead a 24-person enterprise IT service desk and serve as a technical escalation point for platform and infrastructure issues.
- Continue serving as Scrum Master, facilitating sprint planning, backlog refinement, dependency management, and release readiness across engineering, infrastructure, identity, and security.
- Own knowledge-management standards and analyze incident/support telemetry to surface systemic platform issues.

Technical Lead · Scrum Master 2022-2025

Mutual of Omaha · Omaha, NE

- Owned technical intake, dependency management, sprint planning, backlog refinement, and release readiness across engineering and infrastructure teams.
- Built KPI dashboards for trends, capacity, and risk; bridged service-desk operations and engineering during major platform changes.

Business Systems Consultant · Scrum Master 2019-2022

Mutual of Omaha · Omaha, NE

- Translated business requirements into detailed technical stories across multi-team delivery streams.
- Partnered with security and data teams on compliance and integration requirements.

Senior Service Desk Analyst 2015-2019

Mutual of Omaha · Omaha, NE

- Provided advanced troubleshooting across applications, platforms, and infrastructure in a high-volume enterprise environment.
- Authored knowledge content that improved engineering-ticket quality and reduced rework; led onboarding and training.

TECHNICAL PROFILE

CLOUD + IAC

AWS CDK · Terraform · CloudFormation · Lambda · ECS Fargate · API Gateway · EventBridge · SQS · DynamoDB · S3 · CloudFront

DEVELOPMENT

TypeScript · Python · JavaScript · FastAPI · REST APIs · Docker · React · Vite · Tailwind CSS

DELIVERY + SECURITY

GitHub Actions CI/CD · IAM · OIDC · WorkOS SSO · CloudWatch · Cross-account observability · FinOps

AI

Anthropic Claude · Ollama · AWS Transcribe · Vector Embeddings · Semantic Search · Anthropic Tool Use

EDUCATION + CREDENTIALS

AWS Solutions Architect - Associate

Amazon Web Services · 2026

MS, Management Information Systems + MBA (Dual)

University of Nebraska - Omaha · 2024-Present

BS, Management Information Systems

University of Nebraska - Omaha · 2020-2023

Systems Development Certification

University of Nebraska - Omaha · 2023